

Rowan Duskmere

Character Dossier

Boisterous, generous, easily bored radio operator of Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars

Overview

Rowan Duskmere is a radio operator living in Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars. Rowan is 39 years old, originally from Verity Falls, and is known around Dome C as boisterous, generous, easily bored. In conversation Rowan switches to formal speech when angry.

Background

Rowan arrived in Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars 30 years ago after leaving Verity Falls under circumstances Rowan describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Bellwether Cooperative; the second was the one that stuck. Today Rowan works as a radio operator near the water reclaimer and is paid, when paid at all, in co-op shares.

Rowan learned the trade from Fenwick Falkenrath, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Rowan's life is with Xiomara Grimsby, over a matter neither will explain. The person Rowan trusts most is Zubair Oakhurst.

Current goal: to keep Zubair Oakhurst out of trouble for one full season. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: boisterous, generous, easily bored.

Speech pattern: Rowan switches to formal speech when angry.

Tells: when lying, Rowan mentions Umbra the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Rowan Duskmere
Role	radio operator
Home	Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars
Hometown	Verity Falls
Age	39
Favourite dish	twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings
Pet	Umbra, a lizard
Lucky number	225

<i>Workshop password</i>	drift-tide
<i>Mentor</i>	Fenwick Falkenrath
<i>Rival</i>	Xiomara Grimsby
<i>Closest friend</i>	Zubair Oakhurst

Secret

Rowan is terrified of deep water and hides it with jokes.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Rowan: I am the radio operator. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Rowan: Twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings. Do not tell Xiomara I said so.

Visitor: Is Umbra yours?

Rowan: Umbra belongs to nobody. Umbra tolerates me. Lucky number is 225, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 24

Rowan closed early, walked to the water reclaimer, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Rowan won 54 co-op shares from Xiomara on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside the commons; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the commons: 42 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 2, spring of year 24

Rowan found a grain scale half-buried near the rover garage and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Rowan moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the missing shipment. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside the rover garage; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 3, spring of year 24

Rowan closed early, walked to the water reclaimer, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Rowan moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the census. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 4, summer of year 24

the Bellwether Cooperative sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Rowan read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the commons, Rowan taught Zubair how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the census flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside the commons; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 5, autumn of year 25

Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Rowan moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the census.

Entry 6, autumn of year 25

Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an

hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the seed vault: 17 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 7, winter of year 25

Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rowan closed early, walked to the commons, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance.

Entry 8, winter of year 25

Rowan found a glass float half-buried near the rover garage and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the rover garage, Rowan taught Zubair how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right. the Bellwether Cooperative sent a notice about the harvest count. Rowan read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rowan repaired the hand bell at the rover garage for Torvald, who paid in 22 co-op shares and a long story about who really won the regatta.

Entry 9, autumn of year 25

A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside Dome C; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Rowan moved the signal flag indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the rumour of a second well. Rumours about the new curfew reached Dome C. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside Dome C; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rowan spent the day counting stock at Dome C: 14 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.

Entry 10, autumn of year 25

A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the water reclaimer: 57 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Rumours about the quarantine reached the water reclaimer. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the water reclaimer: 2 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the water reclaimer. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 11, spring of year 25

the Bellwether Cooperative sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Rowan read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right. Rowan won 65 co-op shares from Xiomara on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings.

Entry 12, summer of year 25

At the water reclaimer, Rowan taught Zubair how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside the water reclaimer; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Hollis came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Rowan said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 13, summer of year 26

Rowan was hired to carry a cracked compass from Dome C to the rover garage without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rowan spent the day counting stock at Dome C: 25 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. The Bellwether Cooperative sent a notice about the harvest count. Rowan read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Rowan moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the price of lamp oil. Yevgenia came by asking about the comet. Rowan said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 14, summer of year 26

Ingrid came by asking about the harvest count. Rowan said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rowan repaired the ledger at Dome C for Fitzgerald, who paid in 64 co-op shares and a long story about the singing at the docks. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right.

Entry 15, spring of year 26

The weather turned. Rowan moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Fenwick about the rumour of a second well. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the water reclaimer: 9 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the water reclaimer. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 16, summer of year 26

Rowan repaired the cracked compass at the seed vault for Viggo, who paid in 51 co-op shares and a long story about the new curfew. Rowan repaired the wax seal at the seed vault for Wilhelmina, who paid in 18 co-op shares and a long story about the tax on doors. Rowan won 90 co-op shares from Xiomara on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings. Rowan was hired to carry a ledger from the seed vault to the water reclaimer without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 17, summer of year 27

Rumours about the harvest count reached the seed vault. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Rowan for the password to the workshop. Rowan laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Rowan and Xiomara outside the seed vault; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rowan won 38 co-op shares from Xiomara on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on twice-cooked spiced pumpkin dumplings.

Entry 18, summer of year 27

Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rowan found a brass lantern half-buried near the rover garage and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the rover garage: 25 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short.

Entry 19, winter of year 27

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Rowan suspects Zubair and is probably right. Viggo came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Rowan said nothing useful and made tea instead. Fenwick visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 20, autumn of year 27

Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the water reclaimer. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the water reclaimer: 38 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Rowan spent the day counting stock at the water reclaimer: 3 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Rumours about the census reached the water reclaimer. Rowan pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.